5.2 Meaning

Every department in an organisation function independently. But the activities of one department influence those of another department. For example, the activities of the purchase department influence those of the production department and vice versa. Thus, it reveals that the various departments in an organisation are inter-related and inter-dependent. Coordination is a management function in which it acts as a link between the activities of different departments. Every department has its own objective. Coordination ensures that all the departments contribute to the attainment of the goal of the whole enterprise.



Figure 5.1 Coordination is the essence of management

From the above diagram, it has clearly revealed that the way coordination links planning, organising, staffing, directing and controlling. Besides, the concept lies with the attainment of organisation objectives.

5.3 Definition

According to Henry Fayol, "Coordination is to harmonise all the activities of a concern so as to facilitate its working and its success. In a well-coordinated enterprise, each department or division works in harmony with others and is fully informed of its role in the organisation".

In the words of Mooney and Reily, "Coordination is the orderly arrangement of group effort to provide unity of action in pursuit of a common purpose".

DO YOU KNOW?

- **The Indian Railway is operating train throughout India. In that many persons such as signal controller, engine driver, ticket collector and level crossing gate keeper work in a co-ordinated manner by which all of us enjoy a safe and comfortable journey.**
- **In a music band group every instrument player wants to co-ordinate with the main music composer.**
- **ISRO (Indian space research organization) launched heaviest satellite GSAT-11 successfully from French territory located in South American on early morning 02.07 am (IST) on 5th Dec 2008 is possible only because of Indian scientist, engineers and support staffs.**

5.4 Principles of Coordination

1. **Direct personal contact:** Coordination is best achieved through direct personal contact with people. Direct face to face communication is most beneficial.
2. **Early beginning:** Coordination can be achieved more easily if it is planned in the early stage of planning and policy making. Plan should be based on mutual participation. Initial coordination also improves the quality of plans.
3. **Reciprocity:** Reciprocity refers to mutuality among the employees working in the organisation. It states that all factors in a given situation are interdependent and interrelated.

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